

2026 Texas Diabolo Competition Handbook



by Texas Diabolo Association

Registration

The registration information can be found on the Texas Diabolo website registration fee is \$35 per competitor.

The deadline for registration is 11:59 PM CST on Tuesday, December 31st, 2025. Late registration will incur a \$10 fee on top of the \$35 registration fee. We will not be accepting registration after Friday, January 31st, 2026. We reserve the right to close registration early before January 31st if we reach the maximum number of participants.

Music must be submitted no later than 11:59 PM CST on Friday, February 14th, 2026. The music you use for your performance must be appropriate for all ages (more information can be found in the Music Selection section of this handbook). We will review your music submission and send you a confirmation email once it has been approved.

To register please follow the instructions on our website:

- <https://texasdiaboloassociation.org/txdc2026>

Deadlines:

- Registration Form Due: 11:59 PM CST on December 31, 2025
- Music Form Due: 11:59 PM CST on February 14th, 2026

Eligibility

We hope to welcome everyone of all ages! We may ask competitors to show some form of ID to confirm their identity at the competition. Providing false information may result in disqualification. Competitors will compete in either the Regional 18 & Over Division, Regional Under 16 Individual Division, National Division, or Team Division. Please note that only Texas residents with a valid Texas mailing address may compete in the Regional Divisions. We reserve the right to make adjustments to these age groups to maintain competitive integrity. If you are under 18, we ask that a parent or guardian fill out the registration form on your behalf.

Schedule

Timeline (Tentative)	
Day 1: Saturday, March 7th, 2026	Day 2: Sunday, March 8th, 2026
○ Check In ○ Opening Ceremony ○ Regional Under 18 Individual Division ○ Open Team Division ○ Showcase	○ Check In ○ 18 & Over Individual Division ○ National Division ○ Showcase ○ Award Ceremony

Divisions

The divisions will be as follows:

Division	Age Group	Performance Time
Individual Divisions	Under 18	2-4 minutes
	Regional 18 & Over	
	Open	
Team Division	Open	2-5 minutes

Individuals that turn the age of 18 prior to March 7th 2026, the date of the competition, will be considered as a part of the 18 and above individual division.

The maximum performance time is 4 minutes for individual divisions and 5 minutes for teams while the minimum performance time is 2 minutes. However, in order to receive the highest number of points possible, it is recommended to do a routine at the maximum performance time. Judges will time the performance as soon as the music starts, and tricks completed after the maximum performance has been reached will not be considered as a part of the competitors final score.

Contestant Behavior

All contestants and invited guests must behave in an upstanding, appropriate manner. The contestant/invited guest must consider their conduct in their performance, music content, and behavior on the contest premises. Any behavior deemed inappropriate by Texas Diabolo officials may result in but is not limited to: score reduction, disqualification from competition, or ejection from the competition venue.

Music Selection

Music chosen must be suitable for an audience of all ages (including young children and their parents). Contestants who use inappropriate music may be subject to penalty. This includes music with inappropriate words in all languages, obscene language, and inappropriate lyrical content explicit and implied.

Competition Details

a. Set up time

- i. All contestants will have a maximum of 1 minute to set up before their performance. This includes but is not limited to (setting up sticks and yoyos on stage, making sure all yoyos are eligible and functional). In the event that such a contestant's setup time is over and the contestant requires more setup time, a time violation penalty may be enforced. 3rd parties can help the contestant set up prior to performing their routine.

b. Routines

- i. All competing participants will perform a diabolo routine between 2 and 4/5 minutes to their choice of appropriately selected music. Only tricks performed after the music has begun and before the music has ended or the 4/5 minute mark will be considered in the contestant's final score.
- ii. All actions of the participants must comply with safety principles, including safety of the audience, the venue and the participants themselves. If the participants make any dangerous and/or inappropriate actions, contestants may be subject to but not limited to: score reduction, disqualification from competition, or ejection from the competition venue at the judges and organizers' discretions.
- iii. There are no limits to the number of diabolos a contestant can bring onto the stage nor is there a limit to the number of times you can change diabolos and/or sticks, however 3rd parties will not be allowed to untangle sticks for the current competing contestant in the event that they must switch sticks during routines.

Judging Criteria

Judges will score competitors according to a variety of criteria, including difficulty, execution, and performance. Guidelines on scoring will be released at a later date.

Awards

The top 5 highest scoring contestants from each division will each receive a signed certificate. Additionally, the top 3 highest scoring contestants from each division will also receive a trophy.

Contact

Email: texasdiabolo@gmail.com

Website: <https://texasdiaboloassociation.org/>

Instagram: @texasdiabolo

Youtube: <https://www.youtube.com/@TexasDiabolo/featured>